Andrea Neyra-Nazarrett

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Fields

Applied Microeconomics, Labor Economics, Personnel and Organizational Economics, Development.

Affiliations

Weatherhead Center for International Affairs, Harvard University
Center for International Development, Harvard Kennedy School
Digital Reskilling Lab, AI Institute, Harvard Business School
Institute for Quantitative Social Science, Harvard University
David Rockefeller Center for Latin American Studies, Harvard University

Education

Harvard University Cambridge, MA 2027 (expected)
Ph.D. in Political Economy and Government, Economics track.

Harvard Kennedy School of Government Cambridge, MA 2021
Master in Public Policy. Fulbright–García Robles Scholar.

Instituto Tecnológico Autónomo de México (ITAM) Mexico City 2018
B.A. in Economics. Graduated with the Highest Honors.

References

Jesse Shapiro (Chair)	**Emily Breza**	**Jorge Tamayo**
jesse_shapiro@fas.harvard.edu	ebreza@fas.harvard.edu	jtamayo@hbs.edu

Job Market Paper

Managers, Wage Premia, and Worker Effort: Evidence from a Large Retailer *(Solo-authored)*

I study managerial monitoring and wage premia as levers to incentivize worker effort in the firm. Using administrative records from a large Mexican retailer with more than 300 stores and roughly 25,000 workers at a time, I show how the two jointly deter inventory shrinkage, merchandise missing from the store, a loss of about 1.6 percent of sales for United States retailers, on the order of grocers' net profit margin. Exploiting the rotation of managers across stores, I estimate each manager's effect on shrinkage and document what good managers do when they arrive at a store. They are not better bookkeepers: they work more shifts, including nights and weekends, spend more time on the floor with their workers, and rework the teams they inherit, yet on demographic characteristics they are indistinguishable from other managers. Leveraging a company policy that sets wages centrally by position, I document that shrinkage also falls with the wage premium. The two levers reinforce each other: the arrival of a good manager reduces shrinkage by 8 percent more where the premium is high, and good managers suspend more workers in periods when the wage premium is high.

[Latest draft available here]

Working Papers

Training Within Firms *NBER Working Paper No. 33670, 2025*
with Brayan Diaz, Julian Ramirez, Raffaella Sadun & Jorge Tamayo.
Training investments are essential for improving worker and firm productivity, yet their implementation is often

hindered by low participation rates and insufficient worker engagement. This study uses data from three firms, a car manufacturer, a quick-service restaurant chain, and a retail company, to show that variation in training participation among employees is closely tied to differences in middle managers' behavior and practices. Middle managers who actively engage with their employees and emphasize their well-being and development are associated with significantly higher participation in training programs. These managerial differences significantly influence employee performance and absenteeism, especially during periods of organizational change. Together, these findings underscore the importance of middle managers in bridging the gap between centrally designed HR policies and their effective on-the-ground execution.

What Do Good Managers Do and What Do They Leave Behind? *2026*

with Achyuta Adhvaryu, Parker Howell, Anant Nyshadham & Jorge Tamayo.

Using administrative data from a large Colombian retailer and exploiting a manager rotation policy to estimate manager value-added, we study what good managers do and whether their impacts persist after they leave. Good managers increase sales by 12%, reducing stockouts while making inventory leaner, generating larger revenue gains from price changes without increasing the frequency of repricing, and shifting personnel attention toward back-office operations. When they depart, the staffing and inventory improvements persist, but pricing-related gains erode. These patterns reveal a fundamental distinction: some managerial contributions are embedded in organizational structure, while others depend on the manager's ongoing, context-specific judgment.

Work in Progress

Trade Barriers Without Tariffs: Border Tightening and Pass-Through in Retail Markets

What happens on supermarket shelves in Mexico when truck inspections at Laredo and El Paso stall freight for a day or more: scanner data from a large supermarket chain linked to supplier IDs, comparing products from suppliers exposed to the affected crossings with products from suppliers that are not.

AI Tools for Store Managers: Training, Adaptation, and Store Performance

Field experiment in preparation with a large retailer in Mexico. One arm trains store managers to use AI in general and observes which tasks they adapt it to; the other trains them on specific tasks that can be done with AI and measures the impact on store performance.

Local Security Shocks and the Organization of Work Inside the Firm

Worker-level records linked to geolocated crime events: who does not come in and at what hour, how shifts are recomposed, and who is moved or promoted afterward.

Electoral Business Cycles and Everyday Compliance

Inventory shrinkage as a measure of everyday compliance, comparing stores in municipalities where the 2019 mayoral race was decided narrowly against stores where it was not.

Policy Research

VAT Holidays as Short-Term Economic Stimuli: Evidence from Colombia's "Días sin IVA"

IDB Working Paper, 2024

with José Martinez-Carrasco, David Muñoz-Sanchez, Alejandro Rasteletti & Diego Zamora.

Using high-frequency transaction data and a repeated regression-discontinuity design across eight VAT holidays (2020–2022), we find that the policy raised sales in formal businesses by 15% net of intertemporal substitution, with substantial cross-sector spillovers, highlighting the stimulus potential of broad-based tax holidays in developing economies.

Previous Professional Experience

World Bank, Development Economics (DEC) Research Group — Washington, DC — 2020–2021
Consultant, Macroeconomics & Growth. Research assistant to Pierre Bachas.

Inter-American Development Bank, Fiscal & Municipal Mgmt. — Mexico City — 2018–2019
Consultant. Research assistant to Alejandro Rasteletti.

Teaching Experience

Harvard Kennedy School

Teaching Fellow, Advanced Quantitative Methods: Causal Inference (API-210)	2026
Tutor, Quantitative Analysis and Empirical Methods (API-201)	2025
Teaching Fellow, The Politics of Development (DPI-410)	2021
Teaching Fellow, Public Finance in International Perspective (DEV-215)	2020
Teaching Assistant, Advanced Markets and Market Failure (API-101Z)	2019

Department of Economics, Harvard University

Teaching Fellow, Economics of Discontinuous Change (Econ 1818)	2024–2025

Division of Continuing Education, Harvard University

Teaching Fellow, Survey Research Methods (SSCI E-493)	2022–2025
Teaching Fellow, Advanced Research Methods for the Social Sciences (SSCI E-495)	2022–2025

Research Grants

Weatherhead Center for International Affairs, Dissertation Writing Grant, Harvard University
Kenneth C. Griffin Economics Research Fund, Harvard University
Colombia–Santo Domingo Research Fund, Department of Economics, Harvard University
DRCLAS Summer Research Travel Grant, Harvard University
Ash Center for Democratic Governance & Innovation, Research Grant, Harvard University
Harvard Kennedy School Summer Research Fellowship

Fellowships, Scholarships, and Honors

Dissertation Completion Fellowship, Harvard (Mildred Rendl PhD 1954 Fellowship)	2026–2027
Fulbright–García Robles Scholarship	2019–2021
Conacyt–FUNED Graduate Scholarship	2019
Comecyt Talent and Excellence Scholarship	2019
Dionisio Medina Harvard Scholarship	2019
Highest Honors, B.A. in Economics, ITAM	2018

Skills & Personal

Software: Stata and Python.
Languages: Spanish (native), English (proficient), German (limited), French (limited).
Interests: Marathon runner and open-water long-distance swimmer.